

Summary

Keen to build a career in software development, actively growing my skills through real, self-directed projects alongside formal training. Recently completed a 16-week AI-Augmented Full-Stack Developer Skills Bootcamp (Code Institute, completed October 27, 2025), gaining proficiency in Python, Django, JavaScript, HTML, and CSS. Since then I've expanded into React/Next.js and Java while designing and shipping two further personal projects — a full-stack recruitment platform and a published Minecraft mod — deliberately using AI tools to increase productivity while building a genuine understanding of the underlying code. Combines this full-stack foundation with prior expertise in IT, networking, and cybersecurity, bringing strong analytical and problem-solving ability honed across diverse technical and engineering roles. Committed to continuous professional development and excelling in new environments.

Technical Skills

- **Programming & Frameworks:** Full-Stack Software Development, Django & Django REST Framework, Python, JavaScript, React / Next.js, Java, Bootstrap, Tailwind CSS, HTML, CSS
- **Web Development & Tools:** PostgreSQL & database management, Docker, Stripe integration, Heroku deployment, UX optimisation, mobile application development
- **Methodologies:** Principles of Agile Development, hackathon experience (front-end and full-stack), AI-assisted development workflows
- **Digital Systems & Security:** Networking, Cybersecurity, internal database documentation

Soft Skills

- **Adaptability & Resilience:** Paused a technical career to take on full-time caregiving during the pandemic so my wife could focus on frontline healthcare work, then used that period to retrain into software development.
- **Problem-Solving Under Pressure:** Fault-finding on military vehicles and heavy machinery in high-stakes, time-critical environments.
- **Attention to Detail & Compliance:** Safety checks, servicing standards, and accurate record-keeping across every role.
- **Ownership & Autonomy:** Take full end-to-end ownership of current projects (ClearCandidate and gooey-red) — architecture, build, deployment, and publishing — building on early self-directed experience from a hobbyist app-development venture during military resettlement.
- **Clear Documentation & Communication:** Consistent thread across roles, from internal database logging to maintenance records.
- **Timekeeping & Reliability:** Consistent attendance and punctuality across every role.
- **Deadline Discipline:** Met every course and project milestone and submission deadline throughout the bootcamp.
- **Teamwork & Collaboration:** Worked effectively in hackathon teams and pair-programming settings.

Projects

- **ClearCandidate** — Full-stack blind talent marketplace replacing commission-based recruitment with anonymous candidate profiles and flat-fee pricing. Django REST Framework, PostgreSQL, Stripe, Next.js/React, Docker. Built to move beyond vanilla JS into a more mainstream stack while shipping a real, working product. Live: clearcandidate.co.uk
- **gooey-red** — Minecraft mod (Java, NeoForge) adding a wireless redstone-alternative logic system, published for community use on CurseForge. As a stress-test of the mod's own capabilities, built a fully

working 8-bit stored-program computer entirely from its in-game components.
github.com/zZWinterZz/gooley-red

Work Experience

Full-Time Parent (Career Break), Blackpool / September 2020 to Present

- **Strategic Career Transition:** Dedicated time to professional upskilling by completing a rigorous 16-week AI-Augmented Full-Stack Developer Skills Bootcamp to secure formal skills in Python, Django, JavaScript, HTML, and CSS.
- **Current Project Work:** Continuing to build hands-on experience beyond the bootcamp by developing ClearCandidate, a full-stack recruitment platform (Django REST Framework, PostgreSQL, Stripe, Next.js/React), and gooley-red, a Minecraft mod (Java) published on CurseForge — see Projects section.
- **Self-Directed Learning & Discipline:** Actively engaged with digital development and successfully balanced structured technical training with full-time caregiving responsibilities.
- Maintained practical problem-solving and diagnostic skills by servicing and repairing vehicles.

Plant Fitter, Smiths Equipment Hire, Blackpool / July 2017 to September 2020

- **Internal Digital Documentation:** Digitally documented all work on an internal database, maintaining clear and accurate records of maintenance and repairs — a skill critical for software documentation and project logging.
- **Technical Diagnosis and Resolution:** Diagnosed, repaired, and maintained a diverse fleet of heavy diesel machinery, including excavators and dumpers.
- Ensured all equipment was in safe working order and complied with safety regulations.

Independent App Development (Personal Project) / 2016 to July 2017

- Self-directed project undertaken during military resettlement, not a sustained professional role.
- **Full Development Lifecycle Management:** Managed all aspects of the development process, from initial concept through to publishing, using visual programming (Stencyl).
- **Outcome:** Published to Google Play, but commercial reach was limited and revenue didn't cover ongoing hosting costs, so development was discontinued in favour of returning to full-time trade work.

Vehicle Mechanic, HM Armed Forces, United Kingdom / January 2010 to April 2017

- **Problem-Solving & Diagnostics in High-Pressure Environments:** Conducted advanced fault finding and complex repairs on a wide range of military vehicles, including Main Battle Tanks (Challenger 2), Tracked Reconnaissance Vehicles (CVRT), and modern armoured platforms. This required a systematic and logical approach to diagnose failures quickly and accurately, a core skill for debugging software.
- **Compliance and Quality Assurance:** Executed detailed servicing and pre-M.E.I checks (military equivalent of M.O.T). Consistently upheld the highest military values and standards under tight deadlines.

Education

- **16-week AI-Augmented Full-Stack Developer Skills Bootcamp** (Code Institute) — Core modules: Front-end Development (HTML, CSS, Bootstrap), Interactive Front-end Development (JavaScript), Full-Stack Frameworks (Python, Django). Completed: October 27, 2025.
- Gateway Lvl 3 Networking and Cybersecurity
- Gateway Lvl 2 Digital Skills and the Creative Industries
- NVQ3 in Engineering Maintenance and Equipment Maintenance Engineering, School of Electrical and Mechanical Engineers
- Beacon Hill High School — GCSEs